

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	SFT5041
Subject Title	New York Fashion Seminars & Visits
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	The goals of this subject will enable students to 1. Understand the influences of American popular culture on fashion, all levels from high end to low, and to highlight the forces that are currently at play; 2. Familiarize themselves with the American consumer demographics and the psychographics of the dominant and the emerging markets in the Americas; 3. Recognize the leading fashion business establishments in the United States, with special emphasis on New York and to understand what makes them successful in this increasingly competitive field, and 4. Evaluate the effectiveness of various types of retail-marketing as well as production facilities from apparel to accessories in the region.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: 1) Appreciate the socio-cultural orientations in global fashion market. 2) Manage and understand the cultural differences and similarities in an era of globalization. 3) Understand the role of America in the context, the challenges and opportunities in it.

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	1. <u>Fashion and American Culture</u> The elements of popular culture that drive the American fashion industry, including but not limited to music, film, and contemporary art; the rise of street culture and fashion; the phenomenon of celebrity and athletes as a marketing tool; an exploration of fame and its impact on branding; advertising and the sales of goods; the American obsession with sports and its impact on design and marketing; trend of fashion crossover and collaborative marketing strategy. 2. <u>The Development of Fashion Retail and Marketing in the Americas</u> The history of retail and marketing in America; introduction of the most successful specialty, department stores, and the new online marketplace platforms; the mass merchandisers that dominate the American retail scene, such as Amazon, Walmart, and Target; discussion and meetings with representatives of companies. 3. <u>Fashion, Cities and Consumers in the Americas</u> An exploration of the consumer behavior of the American buying public; how shopping has become an avocation for Americans; market potential of South America; sourcing for manufacturing; the "Other Americas" from Canada to Central America and the untapped potential of these countries; market penetration and increased sourcing in the Americas. 4. <u>Apparel Production in the U.S.: History and Development</u> The "myth" and the reality of manufacturing in America, and the reasons; sustainability concerns and production measures in the U.S.; current development of garment production in the U.S.
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	During the course of the program, the students from SFT of The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, as well as those master students from Institut Français de la Mode IFM in Paris) and the Fashion Institute of Technology (FIT in New York) will convene for ten days at each of the participating institutions for an intensive seminar and site visits. The purpose is to explore aspects of the fashion industry particular to that city and that region of the world. Topics to be covered include fashion influences and trend spotting, consumer behavior, major retailers and their strategies for success, and production capabilities. Each participating institution brings a unique perspective to the program. These include manufacturing, merchandising, and global supply management from SFT, marketing of luxury goods with cultural tradition and newest expression from IFM, and product development and wholesaling and retailing from FIT. Students will participate in different class seminars, site visits and meetings with industry leaders. Cultural excursions will be arranged for the students to encourage further interchange among the students

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="3">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>1</th><th>2</th><th>3</th></tr><tr><td>1. Coursework</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>- Reflective Writing</td><td>80%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>- Class Participation</td><td>20%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td></td><td></td><td colspan="3"></td></tr></table> Case study can bring about a deep understanding of the market in the region, further the interaction with students of different cultures can enhance the leadership, organization and communication skill. Written assignment is designed for a reflection in an applied and theoretical manner.	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)			1	2	3	1. Coursework					- Reflective Writing	80%	✓	✓	✓	- Class Participation	20%	✓	✓	✓	Total	100 %								
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Reading List and References	1. Saruchera, F. (2021) <i>Advanced Perspectives on Global Industry Transitions and Business Opportunities</i>. Hershey, Pennsylvania: Business Science Reference. 2. Brondoni, S. M. (2018) <i>Competitive Business Management: A Global Perspective</i>, Abingdon, Oxon: Routledge. 3. Deresky, H. (2017). <i>International Management: Managing Across Borders and Cultures: Text and Cases</i>. Boston: Pearson Higher Education.																																	

	4. Steenkamp, J. (2017). <i>Global Brand Strategy: World-wise Marketing in the Age of Branding</i>. London: Palgrave Macmillan. 5. Burns, L. D., Mullet, K. K., and Bryant, N. O. (2016). <i>The Business of Fashion: Designing, Manufacturing, and Marketing</i>. New York, NY, USA : Fairchild Books.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

(Form AR 140) 8.2020